

"Kestrel 1.5T: Carbon-clogged EGR valve triggers insufficient EGR flow P0401"

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Area: bulletins

1 Condition

Owners of Kestrel 1.5T vehicles may report an illuminated MIL accompanied by stored DTC P0401, "Exhaust Gas Recirculation Flow Insufficient Detected." The condition is most noticeable during light-throttle cruise and may be paired with a mild surge or hesitation. Drivability is otherwise normal and no hard fault is present. For the full code definition and enabling criteria, refer to the Kestrel Emissions Service Manual :: EGR Flow Faults .

2 Cause

The root cause of P0401 on these vehicles is carbon accumulation on the pintle and seat of EGR valve assembly EGR-5140. Over time, soot deposits restrict the valve's commanded opening so that measured flow falls below the threshold the PCM expects. This is a wear-and-deposit condition rather than an electrical failure, so the valve solenoid and harness typically test within specification. Background on the recirculation circuit is documented in the Kestrel Emissions Service Manual :: Exhaust Gas Recirculation section.

3 Repair Procedure

Follow procedure PROC-EGR to inspect, clean, and if necessary replace EGR valve EGR-5140. Begin by performing the system-level checks described in the Kestrel Emissions Service Manual :: Emissions System Diagnosis to confirm the fault is flow-related and not a vacuum or sensor issue. If carbon cannot be fully removed, install a new EGR-5140 valve per the Kestrel Emissions Service Manual :: EGR Valve Service Procedure , then clear P0401 and verify flow under a road test. Complete reference material is available in the Kestrel Emissions Service Manual .